

Abdullah Al Zahid

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Talent Acquisition

Capital Projects Group — Ontario Line, Traffic and Transportation
Metrolinx, 10 Bay Street

Re: Project Manager, Traffic & Transportation, Ontario Line (Job ID 117364)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to be considered for one of the Project Manager, Traffic and Transportation positions with the Ontario Line team. I am an Assistant Planner with the City of Toronto, so I work on the municipal side of the relationship this role manages, and I spent a short placement with Mott MacDonald on the Ontario Line itself.

The posting asks for knowledge of traffic modelling, traffic impact studies and traffic operations analysis, preferably in transit delivery. At Mott MacDonald I ran traffic simulations to estimate how Ontario Line construction staging would affect the surrounding streets, which is the question that sits behind a Traffic Management Plan. At the City I review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them against City standards, and I build and maintain the road and right-of-way datasets the division depends on, so what a project does to the limited space in the right-of-way is a question I work on routinely.

The role is also about third parties, and here the municipal perspective may be useful. I coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and I write the memos and briefing notes that carry those issues to management. Working inside the City's transportation division means I understand the priorities a municipal road authority brings to these discussions, even though permits are not my own area. At Metrolinx in 2023 I saw the same question from the railway's side, assessing what speed restrictions on an operating network would do to service. To keep up with those requests I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not obtained road occupancy or construction permits, prepared or reviewed Traffic Management Plans, or worked on a transit project through construction, and I have no experience with P3, Progressive Design-Build or Alliance models. I do not hold a P.Eng. The Planning Act I work with through development review; the Highway Traffic Act and the Ontario Traffic Manual I know in general terms rather than as someone who applies them daily.

Thank you for taking the time to consider my application. I would welcome the chance to discuss the role.

Sincerely,

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